



Bored Apes crashes Ethereum

Bored Apes Yacht Club collection of NFTs by Yuga Labs crashed Ethereum with a sale, raising \$320 million. <https://digit.in/may22-58>



First retail Meta store

Meta plans to open its first retail store in California on May 9th. <https://digit.in/may22-59>

OnePlus Nord CE 2 Lite

Shines in some areas, falters in some

The market is brimming with mid-range smartphone options and OnePlus has gone ahead and added another option to the mix – the OnePlus Nord CE 2 Lite. This is the watered-down version of the OnePlus Nord CE 2. Faced with competition such as the Realme 9 SE and the Redmi Note 11 Pro+ and the Redmi Note 11T, will the OnePlus Nord CE 2 Lite still prove to be a compelling value for money device? Let's find out.

BUILD AND DISPLAY

The OnePlus Nord CE 2 Lite is a well-built phone but the weight distribution is slightly offset to the lower end of the phone. The back of the phone has a mix of a matte finish and a textured glossy finish. The OnePlus logo on the back is pretty nondescript, which we prefer. The rear panel is made of polycarbonate but it feels pretty robust when held. The right side houses the power button with a built-in fingerprint sensor. The sensor worked decently during our testing period, but there were some instances of misreadings. The left side houses the volume buttons and the SIM tray. At the bottom, you have a speaker, the USB C charging port, and a 3.5mm audio jack (yay!).

The front houses a 6.59-inch display with pretty noticeable bezels and a large chin bezel. So, it certainly isn't a very glamorous-looking display. The 6.59-inch LCD panel sports a resolution of 2412 x 1080 pixels (FHD+). One area where the display shines is the refresh rate. The screen supports 120 Hz refresh rate and 240 Hz touch sampling rate, making it pretty good for smooth scrolling and gaming. The display is also WideVine L1 certified for all your HD streaming action on apps such as Netflix and Prime Video.

PERFORMANCE

The OnePlus Nord CE 2 Lite is powered by the Qualcomm Snapdragon



695 SoC running on a 6nm process. The phone is adept at handling day-to-day tasks such as calling, texting, social media, and multitasking. We generally faced minimal lags and stutters in our regular usage. We also saw pretty great sustained performance with the OnePlus Nord CE 2 Lite.

We ran the CPU Throttling test where the device throttled to 90 per cent of its peak performance after 15 minutes, which is pretty decent. So, it can run pretty close to its maximum potential even after running intensive tasks for a while. We played multiple rounds of Call of Duty: Mobile and we noticed minimal frame skips even at the end of our gaming session.

The OnePlus Nord CE 2 Lite runs Android 12 with OxygenOS 12.1 on top. OnePlus promises two major Android updates and three years of security updates. Now, OxygenOS isn't what it used to be. The phone has quite a bit of bloatware from Netflix and Spotify to OnePlus apps such as Community and OnePlus Store. While some of these can be uninstalled, the whole experience is a lot clunkier than before. Bloatware isn't as rife as on Xiaomi and Realme

phones though, but we're fearful of where OxygenOS is headed.

CAMERA

The performance offered by the cameras on the OnePlus Nord CE 2 Lite is a mixed bag. In daylight, the primary 64 MP lens can shoot detailed photos with good dynamic range and decent colour reproduction, for the most part. However, when it comes to skin tones, the OnePlus Nord CE 2 Lite's camera disappoints. There's an obvious orange tint on skin tones that make subjects look unnatural. This orange tint is exaggerated when you turn on Portrait Mode, which is a disappointment.

BATTERY

The OnePlus Nord CE 2 Lite houses a 5,000 mAh battery with 33 W fast charging. The battery is efficient in daily use. With 120 Hz refresh rate enabled, the phone can easily last a day; about 8-9 hours of screen on time. In our video loop test, the phone lasted for 11 hours and 2 minutes on a full charge. The 33 W charger is capable of topping off the phone pretty fast as well.

VERDICT

The OnePlus Nord CE 2 Lite is a value-for-money proposition under 20K, no doubt. It is a well-built, solid performer with impressive battery life. However, while it does shine in these areas, there are some areas where it falters. The camera isn't great, OxygenOS has quite a bit of bloatware and there are no stereo speakers.

—Dhriti Datta

SPECIFICATIONS

WEIGHT: 195 g | THICKNESS: 8.5 mm | DISPLAY: 6.59-inches LCD | DISPLAY RESOLUTION: 2412 x 1080 | DISPLAY REFRESH RATE: 120 Hz | OPERATING SYSTEM: OxygenOS 12.1 based on Android 12 | SOC: Qualcomm Snapdragon 695 | RAM: 8 GB | ROM: 128 GB | BATTERY: 5,000 mAh | Charging 33 W SUPERVOOC | REAR CAMERAS: 64 MP + 2 MP + 2 MP | SELFIE CAMERA: 16 MP

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